discord-newsbot: how it fits together

v3.1.4, October 2026. One public Discord bot: a morning news digest for the games a server follows, plus Borderlands 4 SHiFT code alerts.

WHERE THE NEWS COMES FROM

Steam news
announcements for every catalog game

RSS feeds
official sites, Bluesky accounts, gaming press (PC Gamer, Eurogamer…)

Bluesky search
public posts that name a game

Reddit r/Borderlands4
read for SHiFT codes only; posts are never stored

mentalmars SHiFT tables
codes, with rewards and expiry dates

Brave Search
web results for comped servers' games, just before a summary

Wikiquote, or a quotes file
the lounge's daily quote

DIGITALOCEAN DROPLET · UBUNTU 24.04 · DOCKER

NEWSBOT CONTAINER · PYTHON 3.14 · ONE PROCESS: DISCORD.PY + APSCHEDULER

Collection pass
every hour
fetch every source, clean up links, drop repeats, store what's new

SHiFT code path (runs inside each collection pass)
spot a code in any source → weigh who posted it → release it once → alert every server that turned alerts on, with its own ping rules
rewards and expiry from mentalmars and Gearbox's own posts; alerts are edited in place for 14 days as details arrive

alerts

Summaries · every 5 minutes
30 minutes before a comped server's digest: web search, then Claude writes the stories; one summary per game, shared across servers

Digests · every minute
each server at its own time, in its time zone
free: headlines · comped: Claude's stories
plus a run report for the server's admins

digests

Lounge
a daily quote, per server
a welcome for new members
(servers that turn it on)

Slash commands
/newsbot setup, status, preview
/news recent, /news search
/shift codes, /shift history

Owner and upkeep
a report every day at 9 p.m. PT
alerts: servers joining or leaving
nightly cleanup (90 days)

owner

every job reads and writes here

newsbot.db · SQLite, WAL mode
items and stories · each server's settings · Claude summaries
SHiFT codes, details and posted alerts · lounge state

config.yaml and .env
the game catalog and sources, comped servers, owner channel; secrets for Discord, Anthropic, Brave

Backups
a systemd timer copies the database at 8:30 a.m. PT, plus one before every deploy

pool-league-scheduler
a separate app in its own container on the same Droplet

ANTHROPIC API

Claude Haiku 4.5, low effort
writes the stories for comped servers; free servers never reach it

Claude call

DISCORD *events in, posts out*

Free servers
a headline digest for each game
SHiFT alerts if they turn them on
the slash commands

Comped servers
everything above, with stories Claude writes; the owner covers the cost
today: Rage Quit Tavern and a survival-games server

In each server
a channel per game it follows, a SHiFT codes channel, and a lounge channel if it wants one

Home server: PacketQueue
#prod-alerts gets the owner's daily report, new and departed servers, and anything that broke

install link

GITHUB · HOW A NEW VERSION GETS TO THE DROPLET

Repository
SomeClown/discord-newsbot
Apache 2.0; changes land through reviewed PRs

GitHub Actions
about 11,800 tests on every push and pull request; builds the image when a version is tagged

Container registry (GHCR)
one image per version, amd64 and arm64

deploy.sh on the Droplet
pulls the tagged image, backs up the database, restarts, and waits for a healthy container

GitHub Pages site
the Add to Discord link and getting-started steps, the privacy policy and the terms

Free servers get a headline digest; comped servers get stories Claude writes from the day's items, and the owner pays for those calls.
Everything runs in one container, and the whole state is one SQLite file on the Droplet. Slash commands and server joins arrive as Discord events.